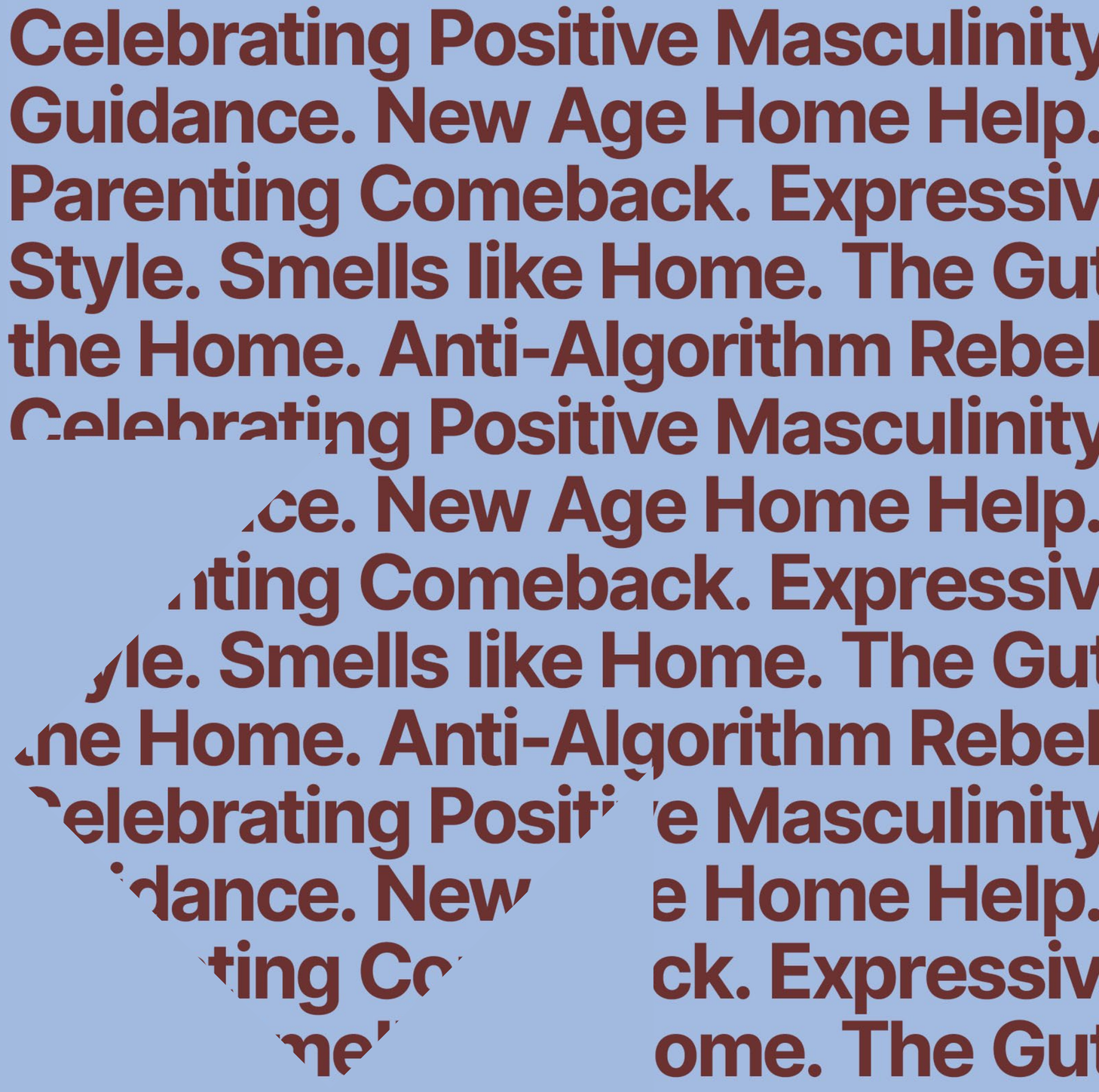
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On The Horizon 2026



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Welcome to the year of positive masculinity, domestic robots and tarot driven intuition.

The idea of “home” is expanding, from a physical space to an emotional ecosystem. Families are blending technology, wellness, and spirituality in new ways, while the next generation of parents is exploring past rulebooks.

Each year, we track the performance of our forecasts and measure the impact of the trends we identify. As 2025 draws to a close, we asked our team of trend experts to share their predictions for home and family life in 2026.

Here’s how our forecasters and futurists anticipate the next twelve months unfolding at home.



Editor: Anna Ward,
Consultancy Innovations Lead

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1

Celebrating Positive Masculinity

2025 created overwhelming noise around ‘The Lost Boys’. Shows like Netflix’s Adolescence pushed important conversations into the mainstream, yet the prevailing narrative still casts boys as a problem to be “fixed.” Talking about them rather than to them has only deepened feelings of being isolated, silenced and overlooked.

In 2026, expect the conversation around masculinity to shift from fear to possibility. With organisations such as Beyond Equality and Male Allies leading the way, the narrative is set to evolve, centring boys’ lived experiences and amplifying positive role models.



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2

Seeking Guidance

Tarot, astrology, and elemental practices are moving from niche interests into the mainstream. Increasingly, consumers, especially young families, are embracing these accessible tools for self-reflection and decision-making.

Aligned with our 2026 Big Picture macro trend, Awe and Wonder, people are seeking guidance in alternative places. They’re looking for ways to welcome introspection and a sense of destiny into their everyday lives.

By 2026, we expect astrology and tarot to become core pillars of personal spirituality. Homes will evolve into sanctuaries for contemplation, and celebrations will begin to honor cycles and shifting energies, nurturing a deeper sense of intuition and self-awareness.

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3

New Age Home Help

The next generation of physical AI is entering the home. Transitioning from novelty to essential domestic infrastructure.

In 2026, expect to see greater smart tech innovation around chore management in the home. Task-specific and rudimentary humanoid robots are poised to move into the early adopter-market, whilst the mainstream market welcomes the robotic floor cleaner. A new question emerges. Is the real luxury now the time that AI frees up for you, and how will you choose to spend it?

Expect brands to package up these AI home solutions with a human-centric focus as we look to invite AI into our most private of spaces and give us the luxury of more time.



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4

90’s Parenting Comeback

Aligned with our 2026 Big Picture baby and kids macro trends, Plugged Out and Beyond the Bubble, Millennial parents are increasingly looking back to their own 90s-era childhoods for inspiration. This new generation of parents are seeking ways to balance their kids’ hyper-scheduled, screen-heavy lives.

Care provision in 2026 will be centred around the philosophy of ‘slow parenting’. Here, we will see that unstructured free time, unsupervised outdoor play, and self-directed activity are championed.

The desired result? Free-roam kids building resilience, learning real-life problem-solving skills, and growing imaginations through exposure to boredom.

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2026: Preferred Future

“Neighbourhoods campaign for weekend road closures, making residential streets car free to enable play.”

Anri Hamilton
Baby & Kids Content Lead

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5

The Guts of the Home

As the cost of health continues to spike, consumers increasingly look for solutions to take medicinal control back into the home. They are focusing intensely on prevention rather than cure.

Shifting into the mainstream consciousness is the importance of gut health, which is now scientifically linked to mental clarity, immune strength, and emotional regulation. This drives the demand for in-home fermentation, advanced nutritional tracking, and supplement regimens. We've seen the impact and importance of packaging in communicating product benefits and as a status symbol of health and cultural relevance.

The gut shift will be a focus for 2026. Products, services and messaging that help consumers to increase gut health from home, will gain traction in the market. Consider the the kitchen counter as the new medicine cabinet.



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6

Expressive Eclectic Style

As consumers grow more confident in shaping their own living spaces, the shift from single-style interiors to eclectic self-expression is accelerating. This trend aligns with the rise of preloved purchasing, driven by climate awareness and cost consciousness, which encourages mixing eras, styles, and second-life pieces.

In 2026 The Hyper Personalised Home will become a dynamic, ever-evolving environment where adaptable furniture, ‘hackable’ components and tech integrations allow people to continually refine and reconfigure their space to match their changing needs, moods, and values.

With preloved consumption surging, consumers will seek out brands that deliver cost-saving, climate-kind products that allow personalisation.

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7

Smells Like Home

This year the fragrance industry has boomed thanks to a predominantly youth audience of self proclaimed ‘frag-heads’. Beyond simply ‘freshening a room,’ consumers are now treating scent as a personal and functional layer of interior design.

For 2026, we expect to see a huge emphasis placed on scent-scaping. The deeply considered use of scent diffusers, candles, and essential oils to conjure specific psychological states (focus, calm, energy, intimacy) at different times of the day or in different zones of the home.

As we explore in our recent Sensorial Living report, engaging multiple senses is a primary objective for many innovator brands as consumers look to balance dopamine chasing lifestyles.



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2026: Product Prediction

“Scent becomes the new lighting, mood-altering, intentional, and dynamic. Expect to see this integrated into functional household furniture.”

Anna Ward
Consultancy Innovations Lead

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8

Anti-Algorithm Rebellion

Opting out in the age of overwhelm is a growing behaviour, particularly amongst gen Z and Millennials, as consumers are increasingly sceptical and conscious of misinformation.

In 2026 growing distrust coupled with a desire for real authenticity, will drive consumers to rebel against the algorithm and instead seek out and find protected space in order to explore personal opinion and tastes.

Human curated ideas and taste sharing will lean on physical interaction and result in growing off-line communities. The Human Edit will inform retail strategies and prioritise small batch over mass production.

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